

Dent in the BRASS



GENERAL
DEEPAK KAPOOR

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The indictment of generals by a court of inquiry raises questions about corruption at the top damaging the army's moral fibre and image

| By Sandeep Unnithan |

For the first time in the army's recent history, three lieutenant-generals and one major general have been held guilty of acts of omission in a single case investigated by a military court of inquiry (COI).

Equally unprecedented is believed to be the recommendation by the Eastern Army Commander Lt-General V.K. Singh for the summary dismissal of Military Secretary Lt-General Avadesh Prakash, an officer who decides all the transfers, postings and promotions of senior officers. A summary dismissal is one of the harshest punishments the military can hand

LAND SCAM

Builder Dilip Kumar Aggarwal leases 70 acres of land from the West Bengal Government in 2005 for a tourism project but fails to get an NOC from the army's 33 Corps.

Aggarwal approaches the army again in 2009 for an NOC for a girls' school. It grants the NOC subject to conditions but the Eastern Army HQ orders a Court of Inquiry (COI).

The COI indicts the chain of command, the GOC of the Corps and his staff officer, brigadier (administration). Establishes involvement of military secretary Lt-General Prakash who is close to the builder and is believed to have influenced the GOC's decision over the NOC.